



YOU ARE **18 WEEKS AND 2 DAYS**

152 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

The sound of your baby's rapidly moving heart muscle can be detected using a simple handheld listening device—the frequency change it produces is converted into a sound that is easy for you and your doctor to hear.

“You may be able to feel your baby's hiccups as they become stronger and more frequent.”

Just like your own, your baby's hiccups are short, powerful, jerky contractions of the diaphragm, causing a sudden rush of air that closes the opening between the vocal cords.

Hiccups frequently follow each other in rapid succession and are often followed by gentle limb-stretching movements. No one is certain why babies hiccup. Perhaps it's due to the immaturity of the nerves supplying the diaphragm, or else to your baby's small stomach quickly becoming overdistended.

Your baby's ears and eyes are now in their final position on his face. The ears have moved up from the jawline and the eyes have moved from the side of the head to lie closer together, looking forward. The eyes move beneath the lids but not yet in a coordinated way. He will open them at around 26 weeks.